accsupp Hidden Text Demo

Demo

Example 1: Visible word, hidden ActualText

In the sentence below, you see a normal English word on the page, but the underlying PDF text layer contains different content.

Normal text before VisibleWord normal text after.

On the PDF page, you will visually read:

`Normal text before normal text after.`

However, if you select the whole sentence, copy it, and paste it into a text editor, you should see that the token `VisibleWord` has been replaced by:

`THIS_IS_THE_HIDDEN_TEXT_IN_PDF_LAYER`

Example 2: Completely invisible hidden text

In this example, nothing visible is printed on the page at that position, but the PDF text layer still contains a hidden string.

Before invisible hidden box. After invisible hidden box.

Visually, you only see:

`Before invisible hidden box. After invisible hidden box.`

But if you select this whole line, copy, and paste it into a text editor, you should find that the pasted text contains the extra token:

`SECRET_IN_INVISIBLE_BOX`

Example 3: Link with different ActualText

We can also make a hyperlink whose *visible label* and *text-layer content* are different.

ClickHere

On the page, you see a red clickable word `ClickHere`. If you click it, your PDF viewer will open:

`https://obvious-url.example.com`

But if you select the word `ClickHere`, copy it, and paste into a text editor, the pasted text should be:

`https://real-secret-target.example.com`

How to test

1. On Overleaf, compile this document with **pdfLaTeX**.
2. Download the generated PDF and open it with a desktop PDF viewer (Adobe Acrobat, SumatraPDF, etc.).
3. Use the mouse to select the example sentences, copy them, and paste into a plain text editor (for example Notepad or VS Code).
4. Compare what you saw on the PDF page with what was actually pasted from the PDF text layer.